

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR
PRESENTENCE REPORT**

Order Accepting Guilty Plea

United States District Court for the Middle District of North Carolina United States v. Mateo Serrano Criminal Action No. SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328 Docket Entry 25 Entered November 18, 2025

Following the hearing conducted today, the court accepts Mateo Serrano's guilty plea to Count One, conspiracy to commit wire fraud under 18 U.S.C. §§ 1349 and 1343. The court addressed Serrano personally under Federal Rule of Criminal Procedure 11, placed him under oath, and examined competence, voluntariness, the nature of the charge, maximum consequences, trial rights, the advisory sentencing process, restitution, and the written agreement.

Serrano stated that he had reviewed the agreement and factual basis with Celia Arden, was satisfied with counsel, and was pleading guilty because he was guilty. He denied any force, threat, undisclosed promise, or guaranteed sentence. The fictional United States confirmed through Bram Ives that the written agreement contains the complete bargain.

The court finds Serrano competent, the plea knowing and voluntary, and the stipulated facts sufficient for Count One. The clerk shall enter the plea and maintain the executed agreement, factual basis, and transcript as separate public docket records.

Findings Concerning the Appeal Waiver

The court separately examined the appellate-waiver provision. Serrano knowingly and expressly waived appeal of the conviction and sentence on any ground, including under 18 U.S.C. § 3742, while the agreement expressly excluded a claim that the sentencing court completely denied him the personal opportunity to allocute required by Rule 32(i)(4)(A)(ii).

The court explained that an ordinary challenge to the advisory role adjustment falls within the broad waiver even if Serrano presents and preserves an objection at sentencing. Serrano accurately described the distinct exception: a claim based on complete denial of his personal opportunity to speak before sentence remains outside the waiver. He confirmed that the exception does not convert every allocution complaint or Guidelines dispute into a reserved appeal.

Arden certified that she had explained the target-specific structure. Ives agreed that the government accepted the same meaning and would not treat the express exception as surplusage. On the totality of the present record, the court finds knowing and intelligent assent to both the surrendered rights and the retained claim. This finding does not predict a later sentencing event or decide how any future claim would be resolved.

Sentencing Issues Reserved

Acceptance of the plea does not resolve the parties' dispute under U.S.S.G. § 3B1.1(b). The parties agree that the fictional activity involved exactly five criminally responsible participants: Serrano, Alina Pared, Corin Bell, Darius Venn, and Nessa Holt. They dispute whether Serrano managed or supervised Pared as a person. The plea contains no premise based solely on management of property, assets, or activity.

The court refers the matter to fictional Probation Officer Niko Faye for a presentence investigation under Rule 32 and the applicable local rules. The anticipated 2025 Guidelines Manual follows from the stipulated November 2, 2025 offense-completion date, subject to the probation office's analysis and the court's independent legal determination. Any draft calculation remains advisory.

Serrano and counsel shall receive authorized access to presentence material and may make timely objections. The fictional United States may respond. The presentence report, objections, and responses remain governed by confidentiality rules; no report is made public by this order. The court will set sentencing after the required disclosure and response periods have been calculated.

Directions and Continuing Conditions

All existing custody, release, and appearance conditions remain in force pending a later written order. The clerk shall serve this order on Arden, Ives, and the synthetic probation office. Counsel shall promptly advise the probation officer of any scheduling conflict and shall protect nonpublic presentence information from unnecessary copying or dissemination.

The plea agreement stipulates a fictional aggregate loss and restitution amount of \$186,400 and acknowledges a \$100 special assessment. Final financial obligations, supervised-release terms, and the sentence remain for the sentencing judgment. The court has made no commitment concerning the disputed role adjustment, total offense level, advisory range, or term of imprisonment.

Nothing in this order limits Serrano's right to be personally addressed before sentence or his ability to present mitigation. Nothing determines that a complete denial will occur. The accepted agreement supplies the governing waiver text, and today's transcript preserves the personal inquiry. The clerk shall schedule further proceedings only by an official notice that provides the required preparation time.

SO ORDERED this 18th day of November, 2025.

Elara Venn Fictional United States District Judge